Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

Finding the Right Therapist: A Simple Guide

A therapist can be a powerful support for your mental health, especially in a high-pressure environment like a law firm or legal team.

Steps to Get Started:

Know Your Options

- Use online platforms like *Psychology Today* or *ZocDoc* to find therapists in your area.
- Many law firms offer *Employee Assistance Programs (EAPs)* that provide free, confidential therapy services.
- *Lawyer Assistance Programs (LAPs)* exist in every U.S. state for confidential support specifically for lawyers.

Types of Therapy

- **Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT):** Helps change negative thought patterns to improve functioning and mood.
- **Psychodynamic Therapy:** Explores how unconscious feelings and past experiences influence behavior and relationships.
- **Mindfulness-Based Therapies:** Use mindfulness techniques to help manage stress, anxiety, and depression.

  Examples: Acceptance and Commitment Therapy, Mindfulness-Based Cognitive Therapy, Dialectical Behavior Therapy.

Finding the Right Fit

- Use the first few sessions with a therapist to gauge the fit.
- Be willing to try a few therapists, but don't demand a "perfect" fit - it doesn't exist.
- If you need to, lean on friends or family to help you navigate the process and stay resilient.

Insurance and Reimbursement

- Many therapists don't accept insurance. Ask about their policy before starting.
- Even if they're out-of-network, you may be able to submit claims for partial reimbursement.
- Ask your insurance company about its out-of-network benefits or see if the therapist offers sliding-scale fees.